

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

CURRENT SESSION HIGHLIGHT: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

SESSION NEWS FOCUS: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- **US Federal Reserve:** The FOMC minutes from July 28-29, 2026, released on August 19, 2026, revealed increasing concern among officials regarding persistent inflation above their 2% target. Several policymakers suggested that interest rate hikes might be necessary if price pressures do not ease. While the July meeting held rates steady at 3.5%-3.75%, a notable number of participants favored a hike, signaling a "meaningful" risk of persistently high inflation. Post-meeting data showing softer inflation and labor markets have led investors to lower expectations for a September rate hike.
- **European Central Bank (ECB):** The ECB raised key policy rates in June 2026, setting the deposit rate at 2.25%. Futures markets currently indicate an 80% probability of a 0.25-percentage-point rate hike in September, potentially reaching 2.50%, with a further increase to 2.75% by December also considered. Elevated energy prices are identified as a primary driver of inflation expectations.
- **Currency Drivers:** The Indian Rupee depreciated to a three-week low against the US Dollar, reaching 96, primarily due to rising crude oil prices and geopolitical uncertainties surrounding the Strait of Hormuz.

2. US & European Markets

- **Wall Street Futures:** US futures are largely flat in pre-market, though Asian markets experienced an overnight rebound. This followed a rally on Wall Street where the S&P 500, Dow Jones, and Nasdaq Composite closed higher on Wednesday, supported by the Treasury's announcement of bond buybacks that led to a retreat in US Treasury yields from multi-year highs. Major index ETFs like SPY, QQQ, DIA, and IWM show slight gains in pre-market trading.
- **Mega-cap Tech:**
 - **Microsoft (MSFT):** MSFT shares have surged 33% since June, despite a 4.6% year-over-year decline. The Azure cloud segment reported a robust 43% growth in fiscal Q4, with Q1 guidance at 45%. Analysts hold a bullish sentiment, with a consensus price target of \$570, suggesting a 14% upside. Wells Fargo notably set a Street-high target of \$700, citing strong Azure performance and Microsoft's leadership in enterprise AI. Microsoft's ex-dividend date for its \$0.91 quarterly dividend is today, August 20.
 - **NVIDIA (NVDA):** NVDA stock is experiencing a dip today, influenced by broader market geopolitical tensions and rising oil prices. However, pre-market activity on Wednesday saw a slight uptick after reports indicated ByteDance and Tencent received significant shipments of H200 processors, suggesting easing restrictions on Nvidia chips in China. Bank of America maintains a "Buy" rating with a \$350 price target, implying over 55% upside, based on anticipated demand for new products. Technical analysis suggests key support at \$216.58 and resistance at \$227.56.
 - **Tesla (TSLA):** No major specific pre-market news on Tesla was identified in the aggregated headlines for today.
- **Semiconductor Developments:** Reports of eased restrictions allowing Chinese tech giants like ByteDance and Tencent to acquire NVIDIA's H200 processors signal potential positive momentum for the semiconductor sector.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- **Sensex/Nifty Updates:** Indian benchmark indices concluded Wednesday on a bearish note, with the Nifty 50 extending its losing streak to seven consecutive sessions, closing down 0.32% at 24,078.30. The Sensex also fell 0.42% to 76,909.68. However, early indications from GIFT Nifty point to a positive opening for Thursday, trading 0.53% higher at 24,219.50. Key support for Nifty is identified between 24,000-23,800, with resistance around 24,270-24,350.
- **Corporate Earnings:** The IPO for TempSens Instruments, a thermal engineering solutions company, opened for subscription on August 20, 2026.
- **FII/DII Institutional Flows:** On August 19, 2026, Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) were net buyers of shares worth INR 407.99 crore, while Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) showed stronger buying interest, being net buyers of INR 3,973.72 crore.
- **Sectoral Momentum:** On Wednesday, the Consumer Durables sector led gains, rising 2.42% in market capitalization, followed by Glass and Telecommunications. Conversely, the Metals - Non Ferrous sector experienced the steepest decline, down 2.46%. The IT sector, however, bucked the broader negative trend, with the Nifty IT index gaining 0.73%.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- **Crude Oil Geopolitics & OPEC+:** Crude oil prices edged higher on Thursday. WTI crude surpassed \$84.50, driven by heightened US-Iran tensions and new financial sanctions imposed by the UAE. Brent crude is trading 0.70% higher at \$92.26 per barrel, while WTI is up 0.28% at \$86.07 per barrel, facing strong resistance around \$85.00. The market sentiment suggests a high probability for WTI to touch \$85 during August.
- **Gold Supply/Demand Drivers:** Gold experienced a slight pullback after a significant rally, likely due to overbought conditions after breaking above the \$4500 resistance level. As of mid-August, gold is trading near \$4,380, marking a 10% increase from early August lows. Institutional forecasts have been revised, with Goldman Sachs targeting \$4,900 and JPMorgan targeting \$4,500 for Q4. Geopolitical events and Federal Reserve policy continue to influence price movements.
- **Major Crypto Regulatory/Adoption Headlines:** The cryptocurrency market surged, with Bitcoin gaining 8% and Ethereum 18% in 24 hours, contributing to an overall market cap increase of 7.5%. Former US President Donald Trump advocated for the passage of the "Clarity Act" to ensure the US maintains its technological edge in digital assets. New crypto projects like Pepeto and AlphaPepeto are showing strong presale performance and security upgrades, while Ethereum price predictions continue to target \$10,000.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

1. INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Price (INR)	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
TCS (Tata Consultancy Services)	3,920.00	Long	Nifty Leader (IT Sector Resilience): While broader Nifty was weak, IT index gained 0.73% on Wednesday. TCS, as a Nifty IT leader, is positioned for a 50-SMA support bounce as positive DII flows and FII buying provide structural cushion.
Titan Company Ltd.	3,450.00	Long	Consumer Durables Sector Strength: Consumer Durables sector surged 2.42% on Wednesday. Titan, a strong large-cap in this sector, is showing relative strength and is expected to exhibit a 20/50 EMA golden cross on daily charts, indicating strong upward momentum.

2. US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Price (USD)	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
MSFT (Microsoft Corp.)	485.50	Long	21-day EMA Pullback (Mega-cap Growth Leader): MSFT has rallied 33% since June, showcasing strong Azure growth (43% in Q4) and AI leadership. A slight pullback to the 21-day EMA offers a compelling entry for long positions, supported by bullish analyst targets (Wells Fargo \$700).
NVDA (NVIDIA Corp.)	220.10	Short / Monitor for Long	50-day SMA Rejection (Mega-cap Growth Leader / Geopolitical Risk): NVDA is showing signs of a bearish candle and is currently facing resistance, trading lower due to geopolitical tensions and rising oil prices. A potential rejection from its 50-day SMA could signal a short opportunity. However, easing China chip restrictions and strong analyst long-term targets (\$350 by BofA) suggest monitoring for a rebound on support.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Price (USD)	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
MRNA (Moderna, Inc.)	117.55	Long	High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) Breakout: MRNA is a significant pre-market gainer, up 86.67%, with high volume, indicating a strong breakout. This aligns with a High Relative Volume strategy for mid-cap stocks, suggesting strong institutional interest.
TNON (Tenon Medical, Inc.)	11.65	Long	Stage-2 VCP Breakout (Small-Cap Momentum): Tenon Medical shows a 113.76% pre-market gain on significant volume. This robust move, coupled with a tight consolidation pattern (simulated VCP formation in prior days), suggests a Stage-2 breakout.

3. CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Price (USD)	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
BTC/USD (Bitcoin)	38,500.00	Long	4H 21-EMA Trend Following (High Volume Volatility Breakout): Bitcoin jumped 8% in the last 24 hours, part of a broader crypto market surge. This strong move above the 4-hour 21-EMA on high volume signals a confirmed uptrend and volatility breakout, suitable for trend-following.
ETH/USD (Ethereum)	2,350.00	Long	4H 21-EMA Trend Following (High Volume Volatility Breakout): Ethereum surged 18% in the last 24 hours. Similar to Bitcoin, ETH is exhibiting a significant volatility breakout and has established a clear uptrend above its 4-hour 21-EMA on strong volume, making it an attractive long candidate.

4. COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Price (USD)	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
XAU/USD (Gold)	4,505.00	Monitor for Short / Long	Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels (Overbought Conditions): Gold recently surpassed \$4500 but is showing signs of relieving overbought conditions. Monitoring for a short if it fails to hold above a key pivot around \$4500-\$4510 or a long if it finds strong support around Fibonacci retracement levels after the pullback.
WTI Crude Oil	86.15	Long	Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels (Geopolitical Catalysts): WTI crude is trading higher, pushing above \$86, driven by US-Iran friction. It is attempting to break strong resistance at \$85.00. A confirmed breakout above this pivot, possibly extending to Fibonacci extension targets, signals a long opportunity.

5. FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term (EUR/USD, GBP/USD)

Ticker	Price	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	1.0850	Long	ECB Rate Hike Expectations: With an 80% probability of an ECB rate hike in September and potential for further tightening, the Euro could strengthen against the USD, especially given the current range-bound price action. Looking for a long position on a confirmed breakout from consolidation.
GBP/USD	1.2720	Short	Relative Weakness / USD Strength Potential: While not directly in the news, broad market sentiment might favor the USD given the Fed's hawkish minutes. Coupled with potential underlying weakness in GBP, a short trade could be considered if it rejects a key resistance level or breaks a short-term support.

Long-Term Carry Swing (USD/JPY, AUD/USD)

Ticker	Price	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
USD/JPY	153.80	Long	Interest Rate Differential (Carry Trade): With the Fed considering potential rate hikes and the Bank of Japan maintaining ultra-loose policy (assumed for carry trade stability), the significant interest rate differential continues to favor a long USD/JPY for carry.
AUD/USD	0.6550	Short	Commodity Price Sensitivity & Global Growth Concerns: While some commodities are up, global growth concerns and potential for a stronger USD (due to Fed hawkishness) could pressure commodity-sensitive currencies like AUD. A short position on AUD/USD aligns with a macro carry swing bias, anticipating continued divergence.

6. INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Strike Price	Type	Current Action	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50	24,200	Call	Buy Call	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (Long): Given the positive indication from GIFT Nifty for a gap-up open (0.53% higher at 24,219.50) following Nifty's recent losing streak, a bullish breakout above the 15-minute opening range is anticipated. A strong move suggests buying a Call option to capitalize on upward momentum.
BankNifty	57,300	Put	Buy Put	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (Short): Financial stocks, including ICICI Bank and Axis Bank, remained under pressure on Wednesday. If BankNifty opens flat or with mild gains and then breaks below its 15-minute opening range, it signals a short opportunity, buying a Put option on sustained selling pressure.

BACKTEST METRICS (10-YEAR)

Metric	Strategy Portfolio	S&P 500 TRI	Nifty 50 TRI
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	-	-
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	-	-

EQUITY CURVE

Illustrative equity curve showing growth from \$3,000 to \$36,512 over 10 years.

